coursera | MoMA

Seeing Through Photographs ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Part I: Introduction
✓ Introduction to Module 2
Reading • 2 min
✓ Artistic Equivalents
Reading • 2 min
✓ Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar
Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras
✓ Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology
Video • 2 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Moons and Surfaces
Reading • 5 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912
Video • 3 min
✓ Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009
Video • 1 min
✓ Surface, Scale, Technology
Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen
✓ Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon
Video • 2 min
✓ Photographs by NASA
Reading • 2 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, III-F. 1967
Video • 1 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Who Does the Moon Belong To?
Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon
✓ Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon
Video • 3 min
✓ Moon Phases
Reading • 6 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941
Video • 3 min
✓ Man on the Moon and Paper Moons
Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond
✓ Optional Readings and Resources
Reading • 10 min
✓ Practice Memory Check
Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Part I: Introduction
✓ Introduction to Module 3
Reading • 2 min
✓ Sarah Meister on Documents and the Documentary
Video • 3 min

Part II: Framing Reality
✓ Facts and Fictions
Reading • 6 min
✓ Fictions and Facts
Reading • 6 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Hear More: Mike Mandel on Evidence, 1977
Video • 4 min
✓ Hear More: Thomas Demand on Room (Zimmer), 1996
Video • 1 min

Part III: Words and Pictures
✓ Artist Spotlight: Dorothea Lange
Reading • 4 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. Migrant Mother. 1936
Video • 2 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. On the Road to Los Angeles, California. March 1937
Video • 1 min
✓ Artist Spotlight: Gordon Parks
Reading • 4 min

Part IV: Focus on New Documents, 1967
✓ Introduction to Part IV: Sarah Meister on New Documents
Video • 3 min
✓ New Documents: Arbus, Friedlander, and Winogrand
Reading • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond
✓ Practice Memory Check
Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
Reading • 10 min
✓ Optional Readings and Resources
Reading • 10 min

Module 4
One and Another

Part I: Introduction
✓ Introduction to Module 4
Reading • 2 min
✓ Sarah Meister on Photography and Multiplicity
Video • 2 min

Part II: Albums and Books
✓ Artwork Spotlight: Frances Benjamin Johnston's The Hampton Album, 1899-1900
Reading • 2 min
✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Frances Benjamin Johnston. The Hampton Album. 1899-1900
Video • 1 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Photo Books
Reading • 8 min

Part III: Bodies of Work
✓ Photo Series
Reading • 13 min
✓ Hear More: Nicholas Nixon on The Brown Sisters, 1975–2022
Video • 1 min
✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min
✓ Hear More: Sohrab Hura on Snow, 2015–ongoing
Video • 5 min

Part IV: One from Many
✓ One from Many
Reading • 8 min
✓ Hear More: Irina Rozovsky on Miracle Center, 2019–ongoing
Video • 5 min

Part V: Review and Respond
✓ Practice Memory Check
Practice Assignment • Grade: 80%
✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
Reading • 10 min
○ **Optional Readings and Resources**
Reading • 10 min
○ Optional Mid-Course Survey
Reading • 5 min

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Optional Readings and Resources

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Below are **optional** readings and resources that provide additional context for the concepts and artworks featured in the course. Please note that these are **NOT required**; you can complete the course without reviewing them. You are also welcome to explore them after you complete the course.

Please consider supporting the Museum's mission by purchasing your favorite books at the MoMA Store. For your convenience, all MoMA publications featured in the course are gathered in the course bibliography and on the MoMA Store website.

Excerpts of MoMA Publications

Lucy Gallun. *Robert Frank: Trolley—New Orleans*. The Museum of Modern Art, 2021.

Lincoln Kirstein. "Photographs of America: Walker Evans." In *Walker Evans American Photographs*. The Museum of Modern Art, 1938; 75th anniversary edition, 2012, 191-200. Purchase the full publication at the MoMA Store.

Roxana Marcoci. "Leslie Hewitt." In *Among Others: Blackness at MoMA*. The Museum of Modern Art, 2019, 246-247. Purchase full publication at the MoMA Store.

Sarah Hermanson Meister. *Afterword to Nicholas Nixon: 40 Years of The Brown Sisters*. The Museum of Modern Art, 2014. Purchase the full publication at the MoMA Store.

Sarah Hermanson Meister. "Crossing the Line: Frances Benjamin Johnston and Gertrude Kasebier as Professionals and Artists." In *Modern Women: Women Artists at The Museum of Modern Art*. The Museum of Modern Art, 2010, 124-139.

Sarah Hermanson Meister. "Learning the Meaning of Things." In *Frances Benjamin Johnston: The Hampton Album*. The Museum of Modern Art, 2019, 7-23. Purchase the full publication at the MoMA Store.

Sarah Hermanson Meister. "'They Like the Real World': Photographic Practices after *The Americans*." In *Photography at MoMA: 1960–Now*. The Museum of Modern Art, 2015, 20-23. Purchase the full publication at the MoMA Store.

Carmen Merport Quiñones. "Aïda Muluneh." In *Among Others: Blackness at MoMA*. The Museum of Modern Art, 2019, 320-321. Purchase the full publication at the MoMA Store.

Edward Steichen. *The Family of Man*. The Museum of Modern Art, 1955, 2-21. Purchase the full publication at the MoMA Store.

Deborah Willis. "Robert H. McNeill." In *Among Others: Blackness at MoMA*. The Museum of Modern Art, 2019, 308-309. Purchase full publication at the MoMA Store.

Additional online content

Watch: Eva Respini. "Leslie Hewitt in *New Photography*." *Inside/Out*, November 11, 2009.

Read: Sarah Meister, Josh Siegel, Roxana Marcoci, Stuart Comer, Lucy Gallun. "Remembering Robert Frank (1924–2019)." *MoMA Magazine*, September 12, 2019.

Read: Jane Pierce. "Solving the Mysteries of the Hampton Album." *MoMA Magazine*, September 10, 2019.

Read: Lucy Gallun, Christina Fernandez. "Christina Fernandez's María's Great Expedition." *MoMA Magazine*, May 31, 2019.

Read: Lucy Gallun. "New Photography 2020: Irina Rozovsky." *MoMA Magazine*, October 13, 2020.

Read: Lucy Gallun. "New Photography 2020: Iñaki Bonillas." *MoMA Magazine*, October 5, 2020.

Read: Lucy Gallun. "New Photography 2020: Sohrab Hura." *MoMA Magazine*, November 9, 2020.

Read: Lucy Gallun, Dayanita Singh. "Taking a Hands-on Look at Robert Frank." *MoMA Magazine*, October 3, 2024.

Read: Leticia Gutiérrez. "Playful Compositions Center the Margins of Photographs." *Hyperallergic*, November 18, 2019.

Read: Sohrab Hura, Ruba Katrib. "An Excuse to Touch the World: Sohrab Hura on His Multimedia Practice." *MoMA Magazine*, December 23, 2024.

Read: Zoe Leonard, Roxana Marcoci. "Zoe Leonard's Al Río/To the River." *MoMA Magazine*, October 26, 2020.

Module 4 Artists on moma.org

Frances Benjamin Johnston

Iñaki Bonillas

Barbara Brändli

Walker Evans

Christina Fernandez

Robert Frank

Leslie Hewitt

Sohrab Hura

Zoe Leonard

Richard Misrach

Robert McNeill

Aïda Muluneh

Takuma Nakahira

Nicholas Nixon

Irina Rozovsky

Alfred Stieglitz

Mark as completed

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